

too. Although my room was a little further from town, it was in a much
!nicer area, but she didn't care

I had naturally assumed that the housemates would want to know all about
the area. The history, crime rates, nearest parks and the nearest place to
have a picnic. I couldn't have been more wrong. The only thing they cared
about when it came to location was, “how many minutes will it take to get
”?to the centre

Convenience beats common sense (4

As well as asking tenants why they didn't take my rooms, I would also ask
”?the ones that did, “why did you choose this room

.Their answers varied but always came down to one thing – convenience

The obvious convenient thing they desire is a place that is close to town.
Fortunately, my rooms were all very close to the Bournville train station so
despite being a few miles away from the centre, it was still an easy and
convenient commute. Never expect housemates to drive because they rarely
.have cars

The other reason that they gave was that the house was furnished. Most
multi-lets are furnished, some more so than others. My kitchen had cutlery,
pots and pans. The bedroom had bedding and nice pictures on the walls.
The communal lounge had a coffee table and a nice television. This made
life so much more convenient and comfortable for my housemates so they
were prepared to move in faster and pay more rent. Purchasing cutlery,
bedding, a TV and a coffee table cost, in total, around £250, but will ensure
that I fill my house much faster and will bring in a total extra rent of around